

Head Quarter West Point Brigade
Muldoon Hill Decm. 4th 1861

General

I am in receipt of your favors relative to Capt. Geo. A. Chase and Surgeon E. Church.

Dr Church has reported for service and is now at the Hospital at West Point.

Our sickness is on the decline on sick report of today showing two hundred and forty six (246) instead of three hundred and thirty two (332) of last week. The character of sickness is also improving, the typhoid symptoms being evidently on the decline.

Sgt James E. Fairbanks, whom you report as arrested claims not to have been mustered into the United States Service. Captain Miller claims that he was, although all the other Sergeants say he was not. At all events his name is not borne upon the Muster Roll for payment made by Captain Miller dated November 30th 1861. Whether he is borne on the original Muster in roll I cannot state as I have never received these rolls from Captain Henry R. King, although he states they were forwarded by express.

Captain Miller's company E is in a terrible state. There has been a personal quarrel between the captain and Sergeant Shain, which has at last culminated in an arrest of Shain upon charges preferred by Captain Miller, and the arrest of Miller upon charges preferred by Shain. I have forwarded both charges to Department Head Quarters and recommended that as both officers were inefficient, and not worthy the time of the officers necessary for a general

not material that a commission be approved and that they be both examined with a view to their discharge

The company is thoroughly demoralized by this personal quarrel and can only be brought into good discipline by the loss of both these officers

I am busily occupied getting the men in comfortable log cabins and trust they will all be housed by the close of this week.

Through the blunder of Company E's Muster Roll I have been through back so as to draw pay from the 20th September instead of the 10th and this carries the entire staff into it.

Nearly all the officers are minus pay in consequence of the new order which will not allow company officers to draw pay until they have mustered the minimum number of sixty four privates. The Colonel and staff until the companies are all full up to minimum number notwithstanding General Orders No 44 and 61.

I am formally assigned to the command of this post and the field work with seven pieces on the hill. This gives me the duties of Brigadier upon the pay of Colonel. This post is the magazine of supplies and military stores for all the troops in our fort, and in addition to the care of my own Regiment keeps me constantly employed and this must be my apology for not writing you more at length than I otherwise should

I am much aided by Lieut Colonel Parkhurst, who is a most-able and valuable officer. He is working very hard and as he is a person of known and tried courage

I have every reason to believe that he will soon become as valuable an officer as the State has in her service

I enclose copy of order assigning me to the command of this Post.

The weather is severe for this locality, the thermometer last night was five degrees below zero and we have now six inches of snow upon the ground. I am glad to see this as I trust it will have a tendency to stop the prevalence of Typhoid which has decimated our ranks.

Our mortality thus far has been nineteen privates and ten non-commissioned officers. I trust that by New Year's day we will be upon our feet hale and hearty. With few exceptions our officers continue well and apt-Surgeon Smith has been both constant in his labor and skilful in his treatment of disease. His untiring efforts entitle him to great praise

I remain

General

Brig. General John Robinson

adjutant General, State of Michigan
Detroit

Yours obedt-Servt

Wm. W. Dubfield

Col. 9th Regt. Mich Infy

Commandg Brigade